

Questions for TriNet

Five questions for the meeting, then twenty-six for the record. Every item here is either a number we derived rather than received, a figure TriNet's own paperwork states two different ways, or a service we are being sold without a price. *The five at the top are the ones that change the decision.*

QUOTE Q-00412887	CARRIER UNDER REVIEW Aetna only	MEDICAL EFFECTIVE 10 / 01 / 2026	ENROLLING 4 of 5 employees	ONYX CONTRIBUTION \$34,800 / yr
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WHAT IS ACTUALLY UNRESOLVED

At least **\$4,560/yr of hard cost** is undetermined — \$3,240 on which service fee applies and \$1,320 on whether we fund dental and vision. Beyond that, the entire \$34,800 contribution design rests on a **70% floor rule we reverse-engineered from TriNet's own numbers**. It reconciles to the penny on both carriers they quoted, but TriNet has never put it in writing. If that rule is different from what we derived, the plan changes.

Ask these five today

THE REST CAN GO BY EMAIL

- 1

Which service fee applies to us at five employees — \$930 a month or \$1,200? Is the minimum negotiable?

Your fee table produces \$11,160 a year. Your footnote and your own cost model both produce \$14,400.

\$3,240/yr

THE ONLY THING THAT CAN CLOSE THE GAP
- 2

Put your employer contribution requirement in writing.

Confirm that fixed dollars of \$300 employee-only, \$600 employee+spouse, \$600 employee+child(ren) and \$1,000 family clear it on every plan on your menu. We believe the rule is 70% of the cheapest employee-only rate, but we derived that — you have never stated it.

\$34,800

WE CANNOT SIGN WITHOUT IT
- 3

Send the Banner Health Network Arizona provider directory.

The ACO 6500 is the best plan in the whole PEO field on our math — it wins both family tiers. But it is narrow-network, and we cannot recommend it until Steven's and Jessica's physicians are checked against it.

your best plan

UNUSABLE IF THE DOCTORS ARE OUT
- 4

Beyond medical, what is Onyx actually required to fund?

Confirm we may fund dental and vision at \$0. Then tell us exactly what is mandatory on life and LTD, at what rate, and whether it must cover all five employees or only the four taking medical. You are the only vendor of the four requiring employer-paid life, and the rate was never quoted.

\$1,320/yr

PLUS AN UNQUOTED RATE

5

What is the all-in expense ratio of your target-date series, and does the \$63 participant fee come out on top of it?

settles the
401(k)

ONE NUMBER

One number settles retirement. ADP has now published its full schedule — target-date 0.48% all-in with no participant account fee. We do not need your whole lineup.

Everything below can wait. The next three worth an email: what your Aetna book actually renewed at on the last two 10/1 cycles · when the \$150 per hour for contribution allocation applies and roughly how many hours a year it runs · Electric upgrade pricing above the basic tier. The full twenty-six follow as a record of what is still open.

1 Which service fee applies to us at five employees — \$930 a month or \$1,200?**\$3,240/yr**

MOVES THE RANKING

Your fee table produces \$11,160 a year. Your footnote and your own cost model both produce \$14,400. Also: is the \$1,200 minimum negotiable, and at what headcount do we stop paying a minimum and start paying per employee?

What we hold: \$14,400 was decomposed out of your \$54,367.45 total, so your model is using the higher figure.

ANSWER

2 Is Josephine billed the service fee even though she waives medical, dental and vision?**1 of 5**

BILLABLE COUNT

Five on payroll, four enrolling. If the fee is per worksite employee rather than per enrollee, the per-head math we have been shown is understated.

ANSWER

3 State your employer contribution requirement in writing.**\$34,800/yr**

WHOLE DESIGN

We believe it is 70% of the employee-only rate of the cheapest plan we offer — \$269.50 against the ACO 6500's \$385. Confirm the rule, and confirm that fixed dollars of **\$300 employee-only, \$600 employee + spouse, \$600 employee + child(ren), \$1,000 family** satisfies it on every plan on your menu.

What we hold: nothing. We derived the 70% from your published employee contributions; you have not stated it anywhere.

ANSWER

4 Confirm we may fund dental and vision at \$0 and have employees pay 100%.**\$1,320/yr**

Our notes say we are not required to fund either. Get it in writing — Insperity imposes a \$27.50 per-enrollee minimum and we do not want to discover the same thing after signing.

ANSWER

5 Basic life and long-term disability: what exactly is mandatory, at what rate, and for whom?**rate**

NOT QUOTED

TriNet is the only vendor of the four that requires employer-paid life. We need the rate, and whether it must cover all five employees or only the four taking medical — that difference is Josephine.

ANSWER

6 Workers' compensation: what class codes do the 0.044 and 0.087 rates attach to?**\$324/yr**

OUR RE-RATE

You are the only vendor that disclosed comp rates, which we credit. Now confirm there is no deposit, no minimum premium, and no year-end audit that can true up against us.

What we hold: we re-rated your rates to our actual payroll and got \$324/yr. Confirm the class assignment for a CPA office.

ANSWER

7 Is there a setup or implementation fee, and is it waivable?**unstated**

ANSWER

8 What did TriNet's Aetna book actually renew at on the last two 10/1 cycles?**10/1 fixed**

CONFIRMED

Allison has confirmed our renewal sits on 10/1 in perpetuity, which we like. Now we need the number, not the mechanic. Give us the book average, not our hypothetical.

Settled already: "renewals are the 1st month of the quarter in which you start" — a 10/1 start holds 10/1 permanently.

ANSWER

9 Is there any cap, corridor or rate guarantee in the agreement — or is the renewal entirely at Aetna's discretion?**year 2**

A large-group pooled rate is the main reason to be in a PEO at all. If there is no contractual limit on the increase, say so plainly so we can price that risk.

ANSWER

10 Can you re-rate us mid-term, and what triggers it?**+\$12,000**IF JOSEPHINE
ENROLLS

Two live scenarios: Josephine enrolls at family coverage, or we add a sixth employee. Either is a 20–25% change in enrolled lives. Angle can re-rate on a 10% swing. Can you?

ANSWER

11 Do the Q-00412887 Aetna rates hold if we decline UHC entirely?

16 plans

We are only considering Aetna. Confirm the rates were not contingent on the dual-carrier strategy.

ANSWER

12 How many of the sixteen Aetna plans can we actually put in front of employees, and is there a minimum enrollment per plan?

menu rule

Our notes say TriNet requires the full menu. If that is right, say so — it is a genuine advantage over a two-package structure, but only if there is no per-plan participation trap.

ANSWER

13 Send the Banner Health Network Arizona provider directory.

top-ranked

NARROW NETWORK

The ACO 6500 is the best plan in the whole PEO field on our math — it wins both family tiers and its out-of-pocket maximum sits at \$15,000 with the plan paying 100% after deductible. But it is a narrow network. We need Steven's and Jessica's physicians checked against it before we recommend it, plus your answer on out-of-area and travel care.

Why this matters most: if Banner does not hold their doctors, our top-ranked plan comes off the table and the comparison changes.

ANSWER

14 What is the new-hire waiting period, and does Jessica have a benefit eligibility date on or before 10/1?

10/1

ELIGIBILITY

ANSWER

15 On the HSA plans — who administers the account, what does it cost the employee, and can Onyx seed it?

fees

NOT QUOTED

Six of your sixteen plans are HSA-qualified, including the HDHP 6350, which has the lowest total worst case of any PEO plan we modeled. Account fees change that answer and we have no figure for them.

ANSWER

16 What is the all-in expense ratio of your target-date series, and does the \$63 participant fee come out on top of it?

one number

SETTLES RETIREMENT

One number settles this. We do not need the whole lineup — a five-person plan will sit almost entirely in the target-date funds. A 0.14% menu average is implausible for a lineup carrying American Funds and PIMCO, so give us the target-date figure specifically.

What we hold: ADP has now published its full schedule in a DOL §404a-5 disclosure — target-date **0.48%** all-in and **no participant account fee at all**, with recordkeeping funded by a 0.22% credit inside the funds. Your \$63 sets the crossover: if 0.14% is real you win above roughly \$18,500 of balance; if your target-date is nearer 0.35%, you are level with ADP at \$50,000.

ANSWER

17 When does the \$150 per hour for contribution allocation actually apply, and how many hours would a five-person plan with a match run in a year?

\$150/hr

PLUS \$1,000 EXIT

Your own cost flyer lists no setup and no maintenance fee — but **\$1,000 to terminate, \$150 per amendment, and \$150 an hour** for match, profit-sharing and true-up allocations. An owner-heavy S-corp plan needs that work every year, so "no employer cost" is not accurate as written.

What we hold: ADP discloses no employer charge of any kind — no setup, no recurring, no termination fee. Your three employer-billed items are now the whole difference between you on retirement cost.

ANSWER

18 As a multiple-employer plan where TriNet is the sponsor, does Onyx still qualify for the SECURE 2.0 startup and auto-enrollment credits?

credits

UP TO \$5,000/YR

This is a real question, not a rhetorical one. The credits are worth meaningful money to a five-person firm and the answer depends on the plan structure, not on us.

What we hold: nothing, from either vendor. ADP is also a MEP with the PEO as plan sponsor, so the identical question is going to them — and to our tax preparer.

ANSWER

19 Earliest realistic effective date, plus eligibility, entry dates, and whether Steven as 100% owner creates a top-heavy problem.

timing

Our read is that a 10/1 401(k) start alongside the medical is not achievable. Tell us the real date so we stop planning around it.

ANSWER

20 Price Electric above the basic tier, and price TriNetExpense, TriNet Perks and the referral arrangement.

unpriced

4 SERVICES

Four separate asks, one conversation — and this is the part of your pitch we actually want:

Electric IT. We spend nothing today and need it. Basic will not be enough. Send the upgrade tiers with real numbers — this is the only thing on your list nobody else offers.

TriNetExpense / Ramp. What does it cost us, what does it cost our clients, and what does the referral arrangement pay? Our clients are on Bill.com paying monthly; ours is free.

TriNet Perks. You described a "company Groupon" for rental cars and gym memberships. What is actually in it, what does it cost, and is it live in Arizona?

TriNetTime. Can it be customized enough to replace Harvest? Our read is probably not — tell us if we are wrong.

And say plainly: what the referral partnership agreement pays, and whether participating in it affects our own pricing.

ANSWER

Before you leave the room

1. **Get the floor rule and the service fee in writing, in the meeting.** Everything else can follow by email. Those two decide whether TriNet is competitive at all.
2. **Ask what happens if we leave.** Notice required at a renewal, whether we get claims and loss experience data, and whether Aetna issues a certificate of prior coverage. A PEO that will not hand back experience data makes the next shopping cycle blind.
3. **Pin the EPLI.** \$1,000,000 is stated — per claim or aggregate, and does it cover acts during the term after we terminate?
4. **Do not compare their figures for our current costs.** Those numbers were invented. Keep the conversation on their own pricing.

Sources: TriNet quote Q-00412887 (Aetna and UHC strategies) · TriNet VR0I · TriNet 401(k) materials · Allison Irwin on renewal anchoring

Every dollar figure on this sheet was re-rated to Onyx's actual enrollment — Lisa employee-only, Christine employee + spouse, Steven and Jessica family, Josephine waiving. No vendor priced this group correctly.